

ATTACK/RECONNAISSANCE HELICOPTER

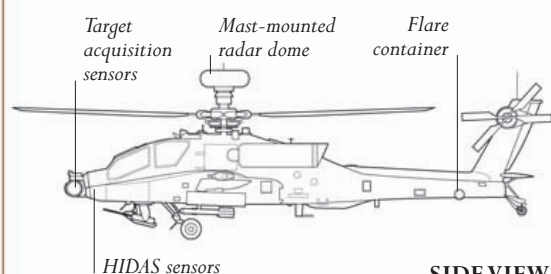
AH-64 APACHE

The anti-armour AH-64 is used by a number of the world's armed forces. It employs many of the offensive and defensive technologies that dominate the modern battlefield.

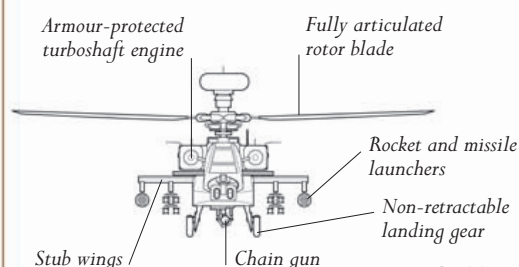
Initially developed by Hughes Helicopters and now produced by Boeing, the twin-engined AH-64 Apache was introduced in 1984. It performed well in the Gulf War of 1991 and subsequently during the invasions of Afghanistan in 2001 and Iraq in 2003. Shown here is the AH1 – a version of Boeing's AH-64D Apache Longbow built under licence by AugustaWestland for the British Army.

The Apache's weaponry includes a chain gun, rockets, and its primary armament of Hellfire missiles. Using target-acquisition and fire-control systems, the crew can merely select targets and fire; the missiles will then lock on to the targets and do the rest. This "fire-and-forget" capacity allows the Apache to take evasive action as soon as it has launched its own weapons.

To make this slow-flying helicopter less vulnerable in battle, the Apache is equipped with a variety of defensive systems. These include the suppression of infrared radiation (to avoid detection by hostile heat-seeking missiles), and sensors that give advance warning of incoming threats.



SIDE VIEW



FRONT VIEW

▲ AH-64D APACHE LONGBOW

The helicopter's fuselage is 15.5m (51ft) in length and the main rotor diameter measures 14.6m (48ft). With a range of 537km (334 miles), the Apache has a cruising speed of around 260kph (162mph).

WEAPONS SYSTEMS



▲ 30MM CHAIN GUN

The Hughes M230 chain gun can fire 625 rounds per minute, fed from a 1,200-round magazine by an electrically driven chain mechanism.



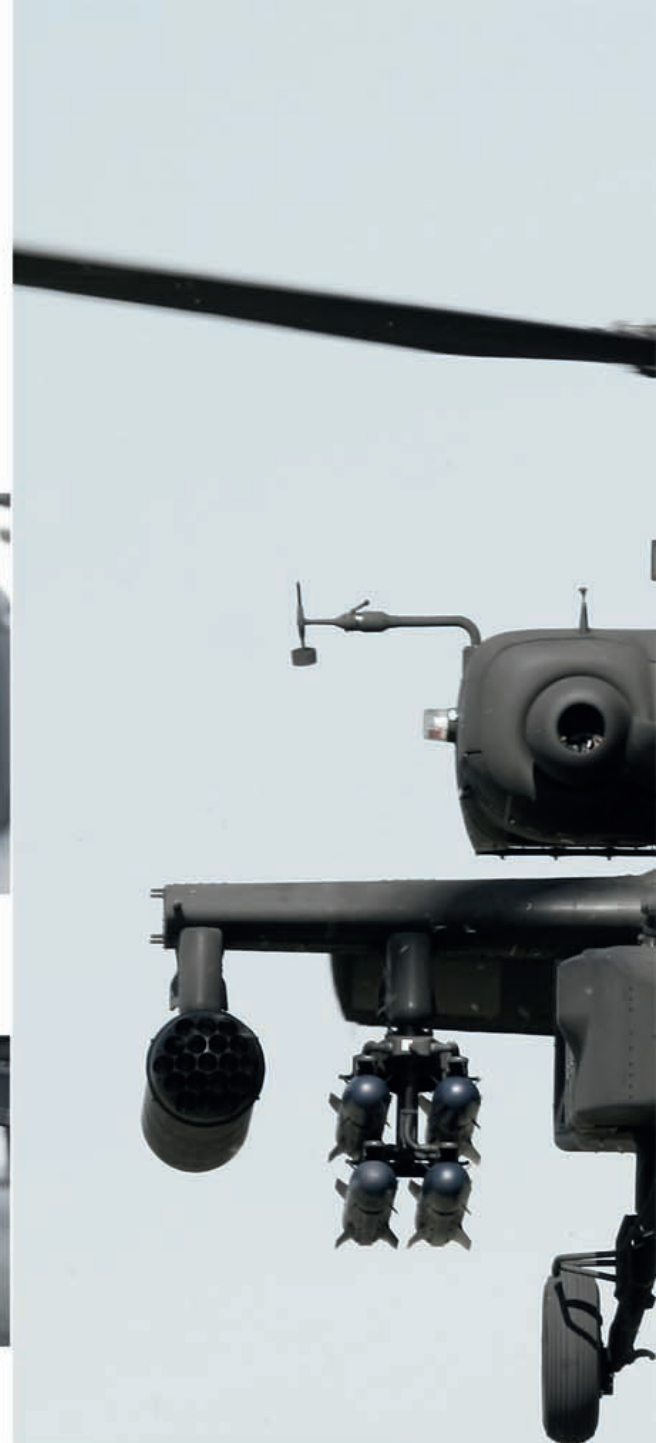
▲ MISSILE

Up to 16 Hellfire guided missiles can be carried (a training round is shown above). These anti-armour weapons have a range of 8km (5 miles).



▲ ROCKET POD

Mounted under the wings, the two rocket pods are for use against infantry and light armour. Each one can launch 19 unguided 70mm rockets.



PILOT'S COCKPIT



▲ INSTRUMENT PANELS

The pilot sits above and behind the co-pilot/gunner. All the helicopter's systems are displayed in both cockpits and managed using the buttons around the screens.